

DEATHS IN THE WINDSOR TORNADO OF JUNE 17, 1946

- ① BEAMAN, JOAN. Wright St, Ojibway. 19, a British war bride died in Hotel Dieu hospital from her injuries
- ② BEAMAN, (unnamed), infant of Joan Beaman, delivered by caesarian in the hospital moments after the death of its mother.
- ③ BEAMAN, WALDO. Wright St, Ojibway. Joan's husband. His pants were found by Mrs Walter Brooker, in her garden on CPR road (between Belle River and #3 highway).
- ④ BEAMAN, MILO. Wright St, Ojibway. Twin brother of Waldo. tott 29 years old had recently moved to Windsor from Petitcodiac N.B.)
- ⑤ Fox, Donna Marie. Wright St, Ojibway. 2yr old daughter of Arthur Raymond Fox and his wife Dorothy Fox, the latter suffering very serious injuries including a skull fracture. The Beamans shared the Wright St home of the Fox family. Donna Marie Fox's body was found in a field. It is not known whether Dorothy Fox survived (still unconscious on June 28, 1946)
- ⑥ JONES, NELSON. Healy St, Ojibway. He lingered in Hotel Dieu hospital for 11 days before dying from his injuries.
- ⑦ JONES, SADIE. Healy St. Ojibway. 42 yr old wife of Nelson Jones
- ⑧ JONES, HAROLD. Healy St. Ojibway. 14 yr old son.
- ⑨ JONES, MARVIN. Healy St, Ojibway 10 yr old son.
- ⑩ JONES, FRANCES, Healy St, Ojibway 8 yr old daughter found by W.H. Coyle under some brush, ^{face down in the mud.} She was bluish purple and her skull was filled with holes and her clothes were blown completely off. She had been carried about 200 yds from the house (See "Anecdotes")

(11)

WAYCHUK, D. Tecumseh.

(12)

SOULLIERE, ULYSSES. Huron Line, Ojibway. 28 years old. Seeing the tornado approaching, he put his family of four into his truck and tried to make a run for safety. The truck was caught in the driveway and overturned killing two of the occupants.

(13)

SOULLIERE, WALLACE. Huron Line, Ojibway. 3 yrs old, killed in truck with his father.

(14)

UPHAM, IDA. 2972 Langlois Ave. 29 years old. Died in Hotel Dieu hospital from internal injuries and fractured skull.

(15)

MacDOUGALL, ARCKIE. Broadview St., Ojibway. 75 years old. Died in the wreckage of his home. He was thrown 100 yards into the air and decapitated. The top of his skull was found in a field 400 yards away.

(16)

MacDOUGALL, Mary Ann. Broadview St., Ojibway. 70 years old. Wife of Archie.

(17)

FIELDS, HELEN. Little River. 69 years old. Killed in the wreck of her home.

(18)

WOGACKO, HARRY. Tourangeau Rd. 50 years old.

Twister Death Toll Reaches 16

Mrs. Ida Upham Dies in Hospital

The death toll taken by the Monday night tornado has risen to 16.

Mrs. Ida Upham, 29, of 2972 Langlois avenue, Sandwich East, died last night in Hotel Dieu at 10:35 p.m. Mrs. Upham was suffering from internal injuries and a fractured skull.

THREE OTHERS SERIOUS

Of the four considered in serious condition, she was the least expected to die.

Mrs. Rose Clark, 55, of Tecumseh, suffering from internal injuries and a fracture of the right leg, is reported improving in Metropolitan General Hospital. Mrs. Clark's condition is reported as "fair."

Two of the remaining 20 victims of the worst tragedy to strike the Windsor district are still reported in critical condition. Mrs. Dorothy Fox, 22, of Wright street, Brighton Beach, suffering from internal injuries and a

fractured skull, is still unconscious. Mrs. Fox has been in a semi-conscious state since her admittance to Grace Hospital Monday night. She has not spoken since she was admitted.

John Nelson Jones, 40, of No. 18 Highway, Sandwich West, in Hotel Dieu and suffering from severe lacerations of the head, back and chest, is still reported in critical condition. Four members of the Jones family, Mrs. Sadie Jones, 42, mother of seven children; Harold, 14; Marvin, 10, and Frances, eight, are to be buried in a mass funeral service this afternoon. Two other boys, Kenneth and Carl, are still confined to hospital.

FREAKISH PATH

Freakishness of the path taken by the tornado was illustrated when the home owned by John Nelson Jones was carried away some 250 feet, while the house of Albert Pare, across the street, was left standing.

Mr. Pare told Red Cross officials last night how he was sitting in the front room of his house, looking out the window when he heard a crash. He noticed the Jones house swept from its foundation and carried away by the tornado. At the same time, the roof of his own house was ripped off by the twister. Seven members of the Jones family were hospitalized, four of whom have died, but none of the Pare family was seriously injured.

SCOUTS DO BIT

Members of the Border Branch of the Canadian Red Cross have received help from many organizations throughout the city, but none have given more of their time than district members of the Boy Scouts Association.

Singled out as an example of the way individuals feel toward helping their distressed fellow citizens is Bob Van Ettinger, 13-year-old member of No. 1 Troop of the Boy Scouts, Amherstburg. Bob was at the Red Cross building at the foot of Ouellette avenue Tuesday morning at 8 o'clock and remained there until long after dark. When he did leave, it was only after being assured that everything had been done for that day.

However, Bob's work wasn't done. He returned again yesterday at 8 a.m. and stayed until officials told him to go home and get some sleep. Bob is doing odd jobs at the Red Cross building, but his presence is strongly felt. Transportation to and from Amherstburg is paid by Bob himself.

Obituary

Mrs. Arthur F. Upham

Langlois avenue, tornado victim, died
Langlois avenue, tornado victim, died
last night at Hotel Dieu Hospital.
Born in Conniston, she has lived in

STORM KILLS TWO IN CHATHAM AREA DAMAGE \$1,000,000

Continued from Page 1

Chatham, June 17—Tornado-like force of the worst electric storm to hit Kent county in a score of years left untold damage in its wake today. Wind like hail and lightning ravaged the district over a 10-hour period, uprooted hundreds of trees, damaged store-fronts, inundated nearly half the country's farm land and took a toll of two lives.

At Erieau, 20 miles from Chatham, over a 100 feet of the dykes protecting the rich Erieau onion lands were washed away and tons of water flooded over the fields. At Mitchell's Bay, 18 miles north of Chatham, the storm ripped down telephone wires, made roads impassable and isolated Vann's Island, three miles off the mainland where two men were reported to have drowned yesterday afternoon.

District Blacked Out

Nearly every village and town in the county was completely "blacked out" last night as scores of hydro and telephone poles buckled in the wind.

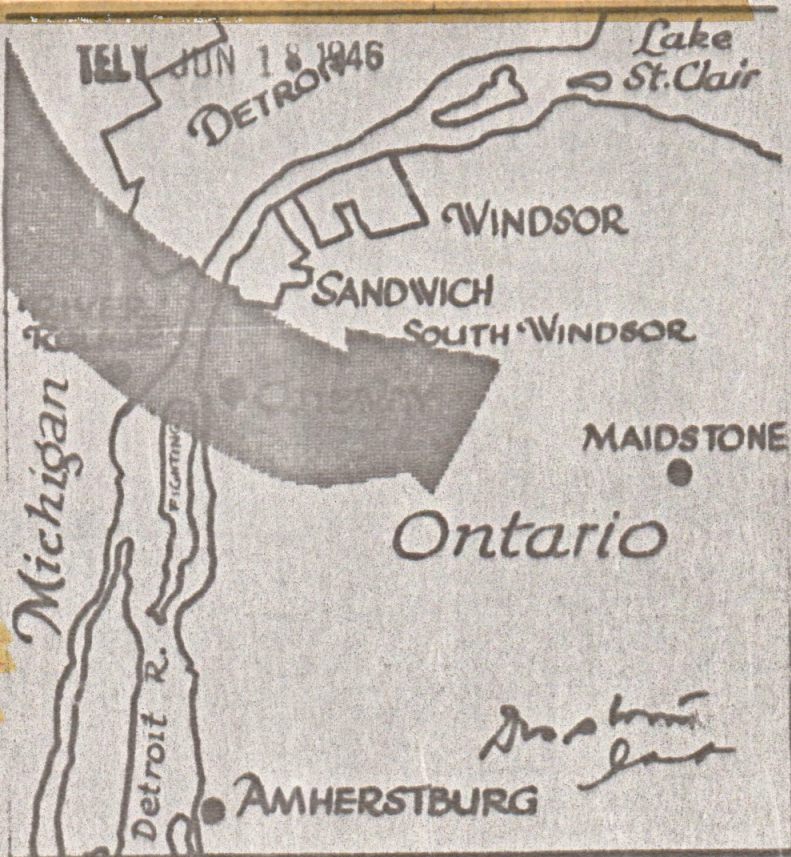
The flat cornland in the Tilbury district was almost completely inundated by the cloudburst which followed the start of the storm yesterday.

Prompt action of the Tilbury fire department saved the buildings of the St. Clair Grain and Feed Co. after lightning struck the firm's warehouse.

Heaviest damage in the district was reported in the Blenheim-Erieau area where waters of the lake and bay were churned into a raging torrent. Although giant breakers beat away at the weak sections of the Erie dykes along the lake front, it was on the bay side that the sea walls gave way, a little over a half hour after the storm began. Water flooded through the main dyke and the internal drainage system and covered more than 1,000 acres of the rich Erieau onion marshes.

In the early stages of the storm roads were covered to a depth of almost three feet.

Alarmed by the first break in the dyke, citizens of Blenheim were called together by the town fire bell and a squad of workers left for Erieau within the hour.



Where tornado struck.

SEEK TORNADO BODIES IN RUINS OF 100 HOMES

Fear Toll to Rise as Search Continues, Hampered by
Floods—Terrifying Funnel Sucked Every-
thing Into Fatal Grip

STAR JUN 18 1946

Detroit, June 18—Police, estimating that at least 20 persons were killed, today directed scores of volunteers searching tornado-razed ruins of more than 100 homes on the outskirts of Detroit and Windsor.

Seventeen bodies had been recovered. Thirteen were in morgues on the Canadian side of the border, and there were four dead on the U.S. side. Police believed the toll would rise as the search continued.

The number of injured receiving treatment in Detroit and Windsor hospitals was estimated in excess of 150, many critical.

Hundreds Homeless

Property damage was expected to run into the millions of dollars in the Detroit-Windsor area. Hundreds of persons were homeless as the wind toppled their homes like so many straws. More than 100 homes were destroyed and 300 damaged on the Canadian side. Windsor was still paralyzed by lack of power.

"Many of the victims were decapitated," the Canadian Press said, telling of a photographer who lifted a heel in a morgue and found a headless body.

Further damage, estimated at \$3,000,000, was caused by floods in the flat lands of Kent and Essex county. Water in places three feet deep rolled over the level fields,

flooded houses and highways following almost 36 hours of nearly continuous rain. Crops suffering most heavily were tomatoes, corn, potatoes and sugar beets.

The official weather report says 2.45 inches of rain fell in Chatham area last night. This figure is unequalled in recent history.

The entire area was cut off as communication wires were ripped down. Telephone operators at Windsor were still accepting only high priority telephone calls this afternoon and said that because there were only three lines operating, even priority calls were subject to "cutting" if more than two or three minutes.

The tornado, which weather bureau officials said travelled more than 250 miles an hour, tore on

Death Toll 15; Damage Mounts After Disaster

Milo Beeman Is Latest Fatality; Thirty-one Still In Hospitals

Nationwide offers of assistance for tornado survivors are being received today by Mayor Arthur J. Reaume and Col. D. M. Brodie, president of the newly-organized The Windsor Star Tornado Relief Fund, as the area counted its fifteenth victim from the twister which streaked through the border area Monday afternoon, leaving in its wake dead, injured and homeless and millions of dollars damage.

Milo Beeman, Sandwich West Township, died in hospital this morning, bringing the district's death toll to 15. Four other persons are in critical condition in city hospitals, and an additional 27 are confined to hospitals for treatment.

Mayor Reaume told city council last night that cities as far away as Halifax had flooded his office with offers of help, and there were many offers, also, from points in the United States. Early contributions to the relief fund have been gratifying.

POWER PARTIALLY RESTORED

While a comparatively small part of the district population was directly touched by the twister, the breakdown of power and communication services affected the whole community seriously. And there was a great sigh of relief yesterday when the rains stopped and again, somewhat later, when Hydro service was partially restored.

The enforced blackout of Monday night was inconvenience enough, but the situation became more serious yesterday, when the Hydro breakdown rendered many industries and businesses helpless, started much talk about threatened bread and milk shortages. Electricity plays such an important part in modern life that its lack disrupted the routine in homes throughout the district. Fears were expressed that great quantities of stored food might spoil, without proper refrigeration. No wonder there were so many exclamations of satisfaction when the lights were turned on again.

As another aftermath of the tornado, communications lines out of Windsor were put out of commission and Windsor was cut off from other Canadian centres, so that it became necessary to route telephone and telegraph messages through American points. These services have been resumed and are rapidly being restored to normal.

DAMAGE, INJURIES

No estimate has been made of the total damage, except to place it in the hundreds of thousands of dollars. Damage at the Windsor Gas Company plant on the Grand Marais road, alone, was estimated at \$150,000.

Fifty homes in the district were either completely demolished or rendered uninhabitable; each wrecked home was a calamity to the family concerned, collectively the destruction was a serious blow to a community suffering acutely from a housing shortage.

Of the 100 or more persons injured by the tornado, 23 are still being hospitalized, four of them in critical condition. Those regarded as critical are Mrs. Rose Clark, 33, Tecumseh; Mrs. Dorothy Fox, 22, Wright street, Brighton Beach; John Nelson Jones, 40, No. 18 highway, Sandwich West, and Mrs. Ida Upham, 29, 2722 Langlois avenue, Sandwich East.

Milo Beeman who died early today was the 15th death from the tornado. He was a brother of Waldo Beeman who died earlier of injuries. Waldo's wife, Joan, and her unborn child were fatally injured. The Beemans came here from the maritimes not long ago and little is known of them.

The death toll mounted to 14 yesterday with the passing of 10-year-old Marvin Jones, the fourth member of the family of Nelson Jones to die. Previously death had claimed Nelson's wife, Sadie, 42, and two other sons, Harold, 14, and Francis, eight.

The dead included an aged couple, Archibald MacDougald, 70, of Broadway street, Sandwich West, and his wife, Mary Ann, 70. Their son, Peter

MacDougald, 33, is being hospitalized for multiple minor lacerations.

Death took a toll of five at the home shared by the Beeman and Fox families on Wright street in Brighton Beach. Donna Marie Fox, the 11-month-old daughter of Mr. and Mrs. Arthur Raymond Fox, was killed, and the child's mother is in critical condition. Mr. and Mrs. Waldo Beeman, and Waldo's brother, Milo, 23, are dead. Mrs. Beeman's newborn child, delivered by Caesarian operation at Hotel Dieu, was the fourth victim in that home, a house that disappeared completely.

Death struck the Soulliere family on the Huron line twice, taking Ulysses, 28, and Wallace, 2½ years old.

The other dead are: Mrs. Daniel Fields, 69, Tecumseh road, Sandwich East; Harry Woeacko, 80, Tourangeau road.

First funerals for the tornado dead will be held tomorrow.

TWISTER IN 1837?

The tornado that struck Windsor was the first in this district since 1837, according to George F. Macdonald, president of the Essex County Historical Society. But W. W. Oak, Detroit weather bureau chief, said he found no record of the '37 twister in his books.

"A tornado forms," Mr. Oak said, "when a stream of heated, moist air becomes carried by a lid of stable air. The heated air builds up pressure until it breaks through the 'cap.' Then, if another stream of unstable air lies above the cap and is met by the lower exploding stream—the result is a tornado."

B. H. Gillett, secretary of the Windsor Utilities Commission, explained Windsor district's power interruption by pointing out that main power lines from Niagara Falls had been severed in at least two places. The first was at the substation on Walker road, where the storm tore the metal roofs from outbuildings and brought heavy damage. Main power lines were also down at Prairie Siding, near Chatham. And the path covered by the tornado, in Windsor suburbs, was littered with broken Hydro wires.

The power breakdown made it impossible to continue operating the filtration plant. Raw water had to be pumped from the river, but authorities explained that it was adequately chlorinated, safe for drinking.

HOSPITALS HANDICAPPED

Windsor hospitals operated under terrific handicaps, as a result of the Hydro breakdown, Monday evening. Candles, flashlights, old-fashioned lamps and lanterns were brought into service. One of the greatest inconveniences at Metropolitan was the fact that the elevator couldn't be operated with the power off, and that's an important item when patients have to be distributed over several floors.

Hospital authorities, though, were more than pleased with the help offered from all sides. Graduate nurses volunteered to relieve the regular staff.

The tornado struck Windsor just before 6 o'clock Monday, coming from

across the river. Persons at Brighton Beach said debris was carried across the river, landing on their cottages. They said the river seemed to boil under the tornado's lash, sending a huge wave that threatened their cottages.

MOSTLY THROUGH FIELDS

After entering Canada, the tornado followed an erratic path around Windsor. Comparatively few houses were in the line of its advance, a route that cut wildly through the fields most of the way. With the same destructive power, the twister would have taken a huge toll in lives and property damage if its course had taken it through the most heavily populated sections of the city. Windsor remained undamaged, and many thousands of Windsorites saw the strange phenomenon without realizing the ghastly trail of damage it was leaving behind.

The heaviest destruction occurred in Sandwich West. Most of the deaths were reported in that area.

The twister swung over to Huron line, a mile or so from the city limits. It badly damaged four flats, housing 16 families, at Grand Marais and Howard. Moving along south of the city's border, the twister struck at Pilette and Clemenceau roads and many homes were wrecked along the Third Concession road, especially at the Langlois avenue intersection. At Walker road the twister created a shambles. Moving away from Windsor, the tornado did its last real damage at the Little River, where the home of Mrs. Daniel Fields fell to bits, killing Mrs. Fields.

MANY SIGHTSEERS

As soon as the cone-shaped terror had passed, word of the destruction spread rapidly and all roads into the devastated areas were crowded with the curious, out to see what had happened.

These scenes of destruction, reminiscent of war-torn areas, held a strange fascination for sightseers, who poured into the district all day yesterday, so that special barriers had to be put up to control traffic.

One man who supplied a graphic description of the onrush of the tornado, said that it seemed to "bounce" along, sending up a puff everytime it struck the earth a vicious blow. He said that it touched down appeared, in many cases, their materials ground into bits in the monster's maelstrom and scattered carelessly over many acres.

The erratic course of the twister accounted for many of the strange stories told of its peculiar behavior, how it demolished one house without so much as ruffling a shingle of the house next door.

Houses, automobiles, and other tremendously heavy objects were tossed about by the tornado. Machinery was wrecked as though it had been twisted by force on a heavy anvil, although it was apparent to everyone that the only force at work was wind—plain, everyday wind that sifts so gently through outspread fingers when it's in a more peaceful mood.

LOSE + MAIL, TORONTO TUE JUNE 18, 1946 p1.

WINDSOR TORNADO KILLS SCORE

HOSPITALS FILLED WITH INJURED, CITY WITHOUT POWER, WATER

Red Cross, Province Rush Serum, Supplies to Windsor

The forces of the Red Cross and a number of municipalities were marshalled quickly to rush relief to Windsor, following reports of the devastation caused by the short-lived tornado that whipped through the section west of the Border city.

The national office of the Red Cross in Toronto despatched two trucks loaded with supplies and two ambulances from this city. Ambulances were moved down from London and Chatham while assistance was ordered from Sarnia. Arrangements for supplies was in the hands of John Marsh, Ontario Commissioner.

Dr. J. T. Phair, Deputy Minister of Health, said anti-tetanus serum and a supply of typhoid vaccine, was shipped by train to the stricken area.

Mayor Saunders announced that Toronto stood ready to do everything in its power to help. The City Council of London, in session, when the news came through, adjourned and organized a relief party including Dr. C. A. Harris, MOH; Fire Chief Robert C. McDonald, ~~Firemen~~ George Gardner and Earl Nichols, City Engineer W. Veitch and two police constables, which left shortly before midnight. Fifty firemen were alerted in the event they were needed.

Windsor, June 18 (Tuesday).—A freakish tornado, terrible in the suddenness of its death-dealing intensity, struck the southwestern outskirts of this border city last night and snuffed out a score of lives. Millions of dollars worth of damage was caused and hospitals were crowded with injured.

The tornado swept across the Detroit River from River Rouge in suburban Detroit, where some persons were reported killed and injured, and levelled scores of homes, mostly frame dwellings in the outlying municipality of Ojibway, and curved around the southern outskirts of Windsor, where it blew itself out.

At 1:30 o'clock this morning 13 bodies had been recovered and identified. Rescue workers continued to search through the wreckage of flattened homes and it was feared the death list would become higher when daylight revealed the full horror of the disaster.

Rush Injured to Hospital

The storm struck River Rouge at 6:57 p.m. (EDT), and within two minutes bounced across the river and tore a 100-yard-wide path of destruction. Power lines were smashed and Windsor remained without electrical power throughout the night.

Windsor, in effect, was isolated from the outside world, except for an occasional priority telephone call. Because of the smashed power circuits there were no lights, radios were useless and this motor city with its great plants was at a standstill.

Scores of injured were brought to Windsor's three hospitals — Grace, Metropolitan and Hotel Dieu — where battery-operated lighting systems and coal-oil lamps were used as doctors tended the injured. The Red Cross set up emergency hospitals in such establishments as the YMCA in downtown Windsor.

Some persons were killed when they took shelter in the basement of their homes and the dwellings collapsed atop them. Others were killed or injured as they raced for shelter and the storm overtook them.

Full Fury Hits Village

Ojibway, a little police village on the banks of the river, was by far the hardest hit and was the most heavily populated of Canadian area lashed by the twister. Although there was terrific damage on the American side, the tornado appeared not to reach its full velocity until it had crossed the river. It not only flattened dwellings but blew debris over a wide area.

Last night and early today, frantic parents still sought children in the area and children cried for their parents. In many cases, the ones they cried for were dead.

Some eye-witnesses said the death toll in the Windsor area would reach nearly two-score, but in the general confusion and darkness accurate estimates were impossible. Full appraisal of loss of life and damage was expected before late today.

Adding to the general destruction, torrential rains, following two days of almost continuous downpour, struck the area in the tornado's wake. Never in the memory of oldest residents had such a twister struck before.

Terrific Whirling Noise

William Laboie, who lives near the intersection of Highway 18 and Seven Mile Road, described the approach of the tornado to the point where it took the most lives and did most damage.

"I heard a terrific, whirling noise and I saw the thing coming at about 50-miles-an-hour," he said. "I warned the folks in the house and

—TORNADO HITS—Page 2

Partial List Of Victims

Windsor, June 17 (CP).—A partial list of the identified dead in today's tornado, was released tonight by Windsor funeral directors who said at midnight EDT that all bodies had been taken to Windsor Hospital.

Mrs. Joe Fields, Little River.

Waldo Beahan, Ojibway.

Mr. and Mrs. Archie MacDougall, Ojibway.

Mrs. Sadie Jones, Ojibway; Frances Jones, 8, her daughter; Harold Jones, a son.

Mr. D. Waychuk, Tecumseh.

Mrs. Fox, Sandwich West, her two-year-old daughter and her infant daughter, born by Caesarian operation after Mrs. Fox was taken to hospital with injuries received in the tornado.

Mrs. Ulysses Soulliere, Ojibway. Wallace Soulliere, 5, Ojibway, her son.

Injured in Grace Hospital, Windsor

Casper Sidrist, June Keeran, Mrs. Sisson and her mother, Mrs. Ida Smith, S. Keeran, Carl Jones, Melvin Jones, Kenny Jones, Peter McDougall, Miss Nettie Soulliere, Al Sisson, Baby Tommy Soulliere, Baby Amaley, Norma Sisson, Bern Sisson, Arthur Perry, Raymond Fox, Mr. and Mrs. George Bolyantu, Mr. and Mrs. Timko, Billy Timko, Mrs. Field of Tecumseh, Waldo Beahan, Mr. and Mrs. Archie MacDougall of West Sandwich and an unidentified man, woman and child.

13
+ MARVIN JONES, 10
+ JOAN BEAHAN

GLOBE &
MAIL

TORONTO

JUNE 8, 1946

we ran to the woods about a quarter-mile away. By the time we got there the houses behind us were gone—just as quick as that."

The tornado apparently originated at the edge of Melvindale, a suburb just north of Detroit. Melvindale escaped, with the exception of a few uprooted trees.

Then it really got underway and as its velocity increased it sucked up just about everything in a 100-yard swath. It struck part of the River Rouge business section, leveling dwellings and business establishments and smashing windows, then headed toward the river, where it ripped through a Government warehouse stocked with surplus war materials. The building was levelled and an undetermined number of high explosive bombs dumped into the river.

United States Coast Guards were summoned to warn river traffic from the dangers and divers immediately went underwater to locate the explosives. Michigan State Police Troopers, meanwhile, were sent to give aid to Canadian authorities.

Train Lifted From Track

There were reports that at Puce, 12 miles east of Windsor, a railroad train was lifted from the track and tumbled about and that cars were smashed.

Members of the Windsor Daily Star staff, working through the night, rounded up all available lighting facilities—such as flashlights and oil lamps—from stores here and in Detroit and distributed them about the city. The Star also lighted its own editorial offices with such lamps.

The rolling, devastating wind ripped into River Rouge, six miles from downtown Detroit, and then smashed across the river into Windsor.

Waterspouts were raised on the Detroit River as the tornado zoomed to the Canadian side, but Coast Guardsmen said there were no reports of boats in distress. The Sandwich area of Windsor apparently was hardest hit by the fury of the winds.

Spectators told of freight cars tossed about like playthings, houses lifted from their foundations, and even bodies being carried away by the wind.

Sprawling Detroit with its more than 1,500,000 population suffered little. The wind was not heavy and the only damage was caused by heavy rain.

Survivors Seek Aid

Detroit's hospital facilities were taxed to the utmost as all available doctors, nurses and ambulances were pressed into service, while extra crews of police and firemen were called in to duty.

Weather Bureau officials said the tornado was reported by an observer shortly after 7 p.m., EDT, and that it directed its fury on the American side before heading for Windsor. It then disappeared.

The huge waterspouts on the Detroit River were indication of a "terrific" disturbance.

Eyewitness reports heightened fears that the death toll may reach several score.

The wing of a plane identified as part of an American Army bomber fell on a house on George Ave. in Windsor in the height of

the storm. No other trace of the craft was reported.

On the American side, the River Rouge community, many of whose residents work in the huge Ford plant there, was sorely beset. Police reported at least 10 dwellings levelled.

Says Seven Neighbors Killed

Mrs. Albert R. Perry of Windsor said at least seven persons were killed a short distance from her home.

The seven, she said, were living in a house across the street from her.

"We saw the house lifted from its foundation," she told a Canadian Press reporter.

"It just came rolling, and rolling and rolling along. I saw the house go up in the air and I saw the bodies being carried away by the wind. I don't know what became of them."

Several hundred Chrysler Corporation workers who were at a meeting discussing strike action adjourned as soon as they got word of the disaster and formed rescue squads to aid Sandwich residents.

Windsor city busses were mobilized to carry victims to hospitals.

Houses Fly Through Air

Observers at Sandwich said the tornado picked up houses and carried them for considerable distances, the occupants still in some of the dwellings.

Dooley Cohane, a Detroit policeman, returning from Colchester, Ont., said he saw the tornado approaching when he was driving along the Canadian side of the river, five miles south of the Ambassador Bridge.

He drove more than 60 miles an hour trying to keep ahead of it, he said, but wasn't able to do so. Debris struck his car as he raced with the wind.

"I saw five or six houses demolished," he said. "When the tornado hit power lines they went up like a flash of lightning."

"The houses went up like puffs of smoke," he added.

Gas Mains on Fire

River Rouge police said they knew of no dead there, but added a belief many were trapped in wrecked buildings. All store buildings in one block were leveled, they said, and several houses were smashed.

Fires were reported breaking out throughout the city as some gas mains caught fire. Trees were uprooted and power lines knocked down.

Police said automobiles were hurled against buildings by the high winds. One church was leveled and several others were damaged. The roof was lifted from a theatre and hurled against an apartment building.

A general fire alarm was sent out in the area. Detroit police were mobilized to administer first aid and prevent any possible looting in the stricken community.

Waterspout on River

An airlines pilot spotted the tornado about two miles south of the Ambassador Bridge, connecting Detroit and Windsor, the Weather Bureau said. The pilot said he noticed waterspouts on the river, a phenomenon the Weather Bureau said occurs "only once in a lifetime," and indicates a "terrific" disturbance.

Four apartment buildings in River Rouge, a community of 17,000, were left a shambles, police reported, and two units of the Fisher Homes housing project were flattened. A number of residents of the project were brought to Receiving Hospital here.

The Rouge plant of the Ford Motor Co., one of the largest automobile factories in the United States, was spared from the tornado's path.

Phone Circuits Down

Bell Telephone officials in Toronto said the Toronto-Windsor-Detroit-Chicago telephone lines went out of commission at 7:25 last night. The greatest damage was caused about four miles east of Windsor, where more than 45 poles were blown down on the London-Windsor line. Two miles nearer the city, another 10 poles were demolished on the Buffalo-Detroit circuit. Some 75 long distance lines were affected altogether, the report said. It was also reported that Bell Telephone emergency diesel generators were supplying electric power for their Windsor buildings.

FRI JUNE 21 1946

Two Reported In Critical Condition

There are still 25 tornado victims in the hospitals today, two of whom are in a critical condition: Mrs. Raymond Fox, with internal injuries and a fractured skull, and John Nelson Jones, who has severe lacerations on head, back and chest. The general condition of the others is considered improved.

Charles Cake who suffered internal injuries was discharged this morning as was Caspar Sigrist, who had many minor injuries. Little Kenny Jones, 5, who has a skull fracture, is slightly improved but is still serious. His brother Carl is also improved.

Mrs. John Clark, internal injuries and fracture of the left leg, is still in danger but not considered critical. Mrs. Deeno Bolsmier, internal injuries, is still serious, as is Mrs. Laura Nantais, with a fractured left leg, and Mrs. Edith Lambden, with head lacerations. Young Arthur Upham, 8, whose mother died Wednesday, is still at Metropolitan Hospital.

WED. JUNE 19 1946.

Injured Girl Out of Hospital

Madein Soulliere, 16, daughter of Mr. and Mrs. Clifford Soulliere, 527 California avenue, was injured when the tornado struck on Monday, and after being taken to Grace Hospital was discharged the same night.

She suffered lacerations of the body, face, arms and legs.

Her father is the brother of Ulysses Soulliere, 28, of Huron Lane, Sandwich West, who was killed when the twister struck. Mr. Ulysses Soulliere's son, Wallace, was also killed. Two other sons, Thomas and Ulysses, Junior, were injured, as was his wife, Mrs. Nettie Soulliere.

New Victims Of Tornado In Hospitals

Five More Patients Given Treatment

Victims are still being received in the Windsor hospitals from the tornado-devastated area around Windsor. Last evening three children were admitted to the hospitals; earlier two adults were taken in for treatment.

EVER SINCE MONDAY

Hospital authorities explained that patients have been coming and going ever since Monday evening. Reports generally were that patients in the hospitals since Monday night were progressing favorably.

At Hotel Dieu, however, it was stated that John Nelson Jones, four members of whose family were buried Thursday, was doing poorly. Mr. Jones, it was said, still remains unconscious and his condition has not been considered good enough to allow his removal to the X-ray room for examination.

At Grace Hospital it was reported that two other members of the Jones family, Carl, 13, and Kenneth, 5, appear to be doing well.

ADMIT 3 CHILDREN

Admitted to Metropolitan General Hospital late yesterday was Sharon Upham, seven months old, daughter of Mrs. Ida Upham, 2972 Langlois avenue, Sandwich East, who died Wednesday night in Hotel Dieu. Hospital authorities said the little girl suffered no apparent injuries Monday night, but she became ill later, indicating possible internal injuries.

Two children were admitted to Grace Hospital suffering from exposure: John, two, and Rose, one, children of Mrs. Kathleen Balyantu, of Gleason road, Brighton Beach. Mrs. Balyantu went home from Grace Hospital Tuesday. At the hospital last night it was reported that her two children there were suffering from severe sore throats.

Admitted to Grace Hospital were Mr. and Mrs. Daniel Puskas, of Sandwich West. Both were suffering from shock, with Mrs. Puskas also suffering a head injury. After the tornado had struck it was stated that Mr. Puskas had undoubtedly saved the lives of his wife, Yolanda, and two small children, Daniel, four, and Ethel, seven. Seeing the twister coming, he herded his wife and children before him and saved their lives by burying them in a pile of hay a few hundred feet from the home.

RELEASE VICTIM

At Grace Hospital it was stated that Peter MacDougald, 53, of Broadway street, Sandwich West, had recovered sufficiently to permit his discharge from the hospital. Peter's parents, Mr. and Mrs. Archie MacDougald, were killed by the twister.

Mrs. Dorothy Fox, 22, of Wright street, Brighton Beach, suffering internal injuries and a fractured skull, was reported at Grace Hospital to be doing very poorly.

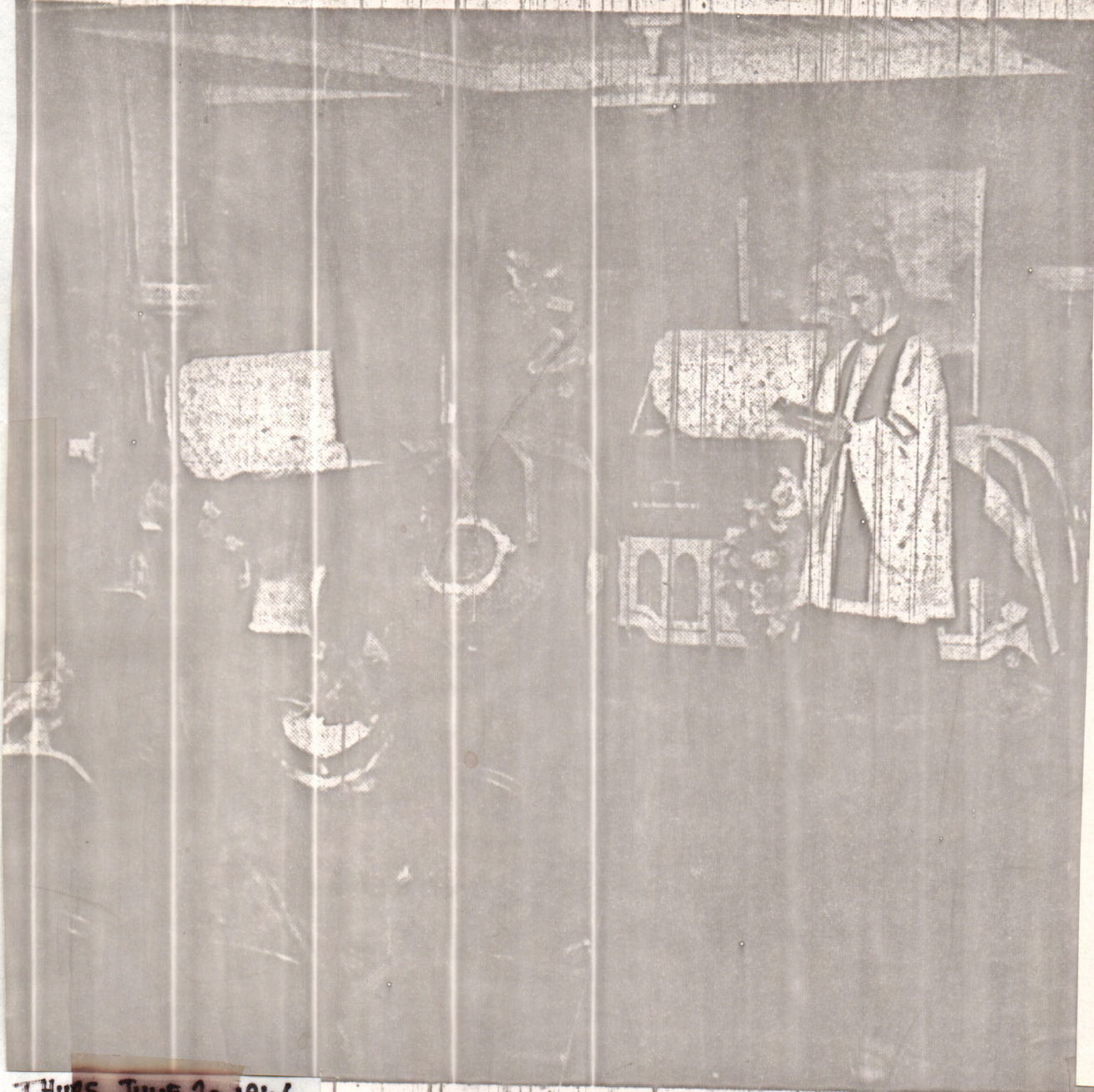
Mrs. Anna Saparozon, 41 of Tourangeau road, who had been in Grace Hospital with internal injuries, was allowed to go home yesterday.

WINDSOR DAILY STAR. FRI. JUNE 21 1946.

Sad Procession Follows Caskets of Tornado Victims



Funeral Services Held For Beaman Family, Victims of



THURS. JUNE 20 1946.

To Be Buried In the East

Of the many sad stories following the tornado on Monday, none is more touching than the sudden fate of the Beaman family. Waldo Beaman, and his 19-year-old British war bride, both died at the hospital, where Mrs. Beaman gave birth to a child by an emergency caesarian section. The baby was stillborn. Waldo's twin brother, Milo, was also killed, and leaves his wife and child at Riverside, N.B.

The bodies are being sent to Fairbairn, New Brunswick, for burial. The brothers' parents, Mr. and Mrs. Oliver P. Beaman, are living at Lutz Mountain, N.B., where the boys lived, before coming to Windsor.

At the mass funeral of the Beaman family Saturday, Rev. B. A. Silcox conducted the last rites for Mr. and Mrs. Waldo Beaman, their newborn child, and Mr. Milo Beaman, twin brother of Waldo, victims of the tragic tornado which struck near Windsor last Monday evening. The bodies were shipped to relatives at Petitcodiac, New Brunswick for burial following the services at Albemly J. Janisse and Son Funeral Home.

(Star Staff Photo)

Funeral Services Are Held For Four Tornado Victims

Services were held Saturday, at the Albemly J. Janisse and Son Funeral Home, 411 Sandwich street east, for Waldo Beaman, 26, his wife, Sylvia Joan, 20, their infant child, and Milo Beaman, twin brother of Waldo.

The four were victims of the tornado that struck the Windsor area last Monday evening.

The Beaman family came only recently to Windsor from Petitcodiac, New Brunswick. The whole Windsor family was wiped out when the tragedy hit.

Rev. B. A. Silcox officiated at the last rites. "God did not bring this to pass," he said. "There is victory in death. It is we who are still living who wonder and wait."

"God did not bring this to punish us. We should not lose faith in God as a result of this calamity. The tornado was a freak of nature, and we must not blame God for it."

The friends of the deceased joined in the repetition of the Lord's Prayer. The service ended with a benediction pronounced by Rev. Mr. Silcox.

The bodies were sent to Petitcodiac, New Brunswick, for burial.

Carl Jones Cheerful Despite Tragedy That Struck



Recovering from a broken leg suffered in the tornado, Carl Jones is shown in Grace Hospital with Dr. J. C. McLister attending.

Carl lost his mother, two brothers and a sister in the twister. His father is in a very serious condition. (By Staff Photographer.)

WED. JULY 3 1946

17th Tornado Victim Buried

Funeral services were conducted yesterday for Nelson Jones, 17th victim of the tornado.

Carl Jones, 13, was allowed to accompany his father's funeral procession on a stretcher. Carl is presently being treated at Grace Hospital for injuries received when his home was destroyed by the twister.

The service was attended by many friends of the Jones family.

Burial was in St. John's Cemetery, Amherstburg.

1st Tornado Death Toll Rises to 17

John Nelson Jones Dies in Hospital

On the heels of the second tornado to strike the Windsor district within 12 days was the report from Hotel Dieu of the death of John Nelson Jones, No. 18 Highway, Sandwich West.

5TH DEATH IN FAMILY

Mr. Jones was 40 years of age and was suffering from severe lacerations to the head, back and chest. He is the 17th casualty of the first tornado which struck on June 17.

Father of seven children, Mr. Jones was not expected to live from the time he was first admitted to Hotel Dieu the night of the tragedy. His wife and three children, Marvin, Harold and Frances were buried at a mass funeral last Thursday afternoon.

The body will rest at Anderson's Funeral Home, 861 Ouellette avenue.

Four children survive. They are Ruth, 16, and Ernest, 18, neither of whom were home at the time the twister struck; Carl, 13, confined to Grace Hospital with a fractured leg, and Kenneth, 5, also in Grace Hospital with a fractured skull.

Funeral service for Mr. Jones will be at the Anderson Funeral Home, 861 Ouellette avenue, on Monday at 2 p.m. Officiating will be Rev. H. M. Paulin, assisted by Rev. B. A. Silcox, at the cemetery. Burial will be in St. John's Cemetery.

ONE STILL UNCONSCIOUS

Only one other injured person is still considered in critical condition. Mrs. Dorothy Fox, of Wright street, Brighton Beach, has not regained consciousness since she was admitted a week ago Monday night. She is suffering from a fractured skull and numerous internal injuries.

Nine others are still confined to hospitals. They include:

Mrs. Annie Oke, 66, of 3560 Liberty street, Sandwich East, head injuries.

Two Upham children; 2972 Langlois avenue, readmitted to hospital two days after tornado struck.

Mrs. Rose Clark, 59, of Tecumseh, internal injuries and fracture of left leg.

Mrs. Deena Boisier, of Sandwich East, lacerations of the head and face.

Kenneth and Carl Jones.

John and Rose Bulyant, two and one years, both suffering from exposure.



The last rites are said for the family of Mr. Nelson Jones, Mrs. Jones, Harpold, Marvin and Frances, who met their death so tragically in the tornado Monday night. In the top picture, a sad procession of not only friends of the family and relatives but many from Windsor who came in sympathy, enters St. John's Cemetery yesterday afternoon. The funeral service, one of the largest in the history of the city, was held at the Anderson

Funeral Home on Ouellette avenue, where the service was held with sympathizers, many of whom followed to the graveside. The bottom picture shows Rev. D.D. and Very Rev. Ven. Archdeacon H. P. We at the graveside with bowed heads before the four caskets were lowered into the earth.